

GOD'S HEART FOR THE NATIONS

God's Word

God's Word is central to establishing our foundation. As a follower of Christ, our aim is to make God's purpose our purpose, and find our story in the greater story God has for the world. Look up and make observations about the following verses.

- Genesis 12:1-2
- Psalm 67:1-2
- Isaiah 49:6
- Matthew 28:19-20
- Matthew 24:14
- Revelation 7:9

After reading through each of the verses, how would you describe God's purpose on this earth?

God's World

To best step into God's story for the world, it is helpful to know the current state of the world (as of 2024).



- The 10/40 window is the rectangular area of North Africa, the Middle East, and Asia approximately between 10 degrees north and 40 degrees north (latitude). One-third of the earth's total land area and nearly two-thirds of the world's people live in the 10/40 window.
- 90% of the people living in the 10/40 Window are un-evangelized. Many have never heard the Gospel message and don't know any Christians. If those groups are to be evangelized, believers will need to leave their own culture, perhaps even learning a new language, in order to communicate the gospel.
- 80% of the poorest people in the world live in this window (living on less than $500 per year).
- 60% of international students come from this area of the world.
- 8% of the world's Christian missionaries work in the 10/40 Window.
- Only $0.01 out of every $100 given to missions goes to take the Gospel to unreached people living in this part of the world.

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An easy way to remember the five major world religons is the acronym THUMB:

Religion	Population (2024)
Tribal	400 Million
Hindu	1.2 Billion
Unreligious	1.1 Billion
Muslim	1.9 Billion
Buddhist	535 Million

What stood out to you about God's World?

God's Work

In light of God's word and the needs in God's world, there is great need to be engaged in God's story around the world. Believers can practice these five habits listed below to engage in God's global work.

1. **Goer** -- One who goes to one of the unreached people groups.
2. **Sender** -- One who supports those who go through prayer, service and finances.
3. **Prayer** -- One who prays for the advancement of God's Kingdom in the world.
4. **Welcomer** -- One who works with internationals here.
5. **Mobilizer** -- One who recruits others to embrace God's heart for the nations.

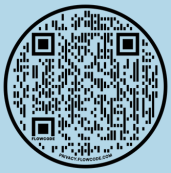
Discussion

- How would you evaluate yourself in the following areas (consider a 1-10 scale, with 1 being little to no interest or involvement and 10 being a word Christian).

    1. The biblical basis for missions.
    2. The current status of world evangelization
    3. The various habits/roles of being a world Christian

- Where do you think God wants you on this scale? Why?
- How will you get from where you are now to where God wants you? What is your plan?
- What do you think are some of the obstacles and sacrifices you may have to make to get there?
- Consider the resources below. What are 1 or 2 resources you would like to incorporate into your life in order to grow in this area?

Additional resources



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